

# “4G and WiMAX are optimised for what people want to do on their smartphones”



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## How does WiMAX technology compare with time-division duplex version of long-term evolution (TD-LTE)?

It compares favourably on many fronts. In terms of performance, both technologies are remarkably similar. However, while WiMAX is actually available, TD-LTE is two-three years away. So in the near future, WiMAX remains the technology of choice.

## What potential does it hold for India? Do we really need WiMAX?

India needs 4G. It needs more broadband connected users. And WiMAX is ready for India in terms of advanced ecosystem with correctly priced products.

## How has been the technology uptake in India so far?

WiMAX has been present in India for many years. BSNL has started quite an ambitious programme in rural areas to provide connectivity to 600,000 villages around India. Spec-

According to a research by Protiviti, every six months of broadband deployment delays will cost the Indian economy \$1 billion in lost revenue. Additionally, it will delay the creation of more than two million jobs nationally per 12 million added broadband subscribers based on the increased opportunities that a broadband-rich economy creates.

The WiMAX Forum is an industry-led organisation formed to certify and promote the compatibility and interoperability of broadband wireless products based upon the harmonised IEEE 802.16e/ETSI HiperMAN standard. Declan Byrne, director of marketing of the WiMAX Forum, was recently in New Delhi for the 7th WiMAX India 2010 International Conference and spoke to Uma Bansal, deputy editor at EFY, about why WiMAX is the way to go for a country thirsty for broadband, like India.

trum auction has just now occurred and we expect some pretty aggressive action in the near future.

## ADSL + WiFi is seen as a strong competitor to WiMAX in India. Why?

ADSL is a great technology. It certainly delivers bit throughput. But in terms of performance, compared to WiMAX, it is a weak alternative. It delivers last bandwidth, last throughput and does it so more expensively. India has ten million broadband users and, as per government objective, if you want to add another 90 million over the next ten years and deploy wired technologies like ADSL or fibre, it will take so long with rights-of-way permission, digging trenches, laying wires, etc. So to meet the ambitious objective of the Indian government, WiMAX is probably the only solution.

## Other challenges for WiMAX in India?